

Kaua'i Saw School — field card

Not a certification. Reference only. Follow your crew boss and your manual.

IF A LINE IS DOWN

Assume it is energized. Stay 30 ft back.

911 first

KIUC 808-246-4300

811 before any digging (or 866-423-7287)

Never cut a tree touching, near, or able to reach a line. Feet together, small shuffling steps to get clear — never a stride. Line on a vehicle: stay inside, call 911, only exit for fire and then jump clear.

BEFORE EVERY CUT

What is holding this up? Where does it go when it moves?

Cannot answer both, out loud? Do not cut. Flag it and wait.

PRE-START, IN ORDER

1. Chain brake — test it, chain must stop
2. Chain catcher present
3. Bar rails, groove, oil hole clear
4. Chain sharp, tension right, links undamaged
5. Sprocket wear · E-clip + washer on
6. Bar nuts tight
7. Air filter clean AND sealed
8. Plug and boot (carry a spare)
9. Fuel + bar oil both full
10. Muffler screen clear
11. AV mounts, bolts, no cracks
12. Starter cord good

CREW BRIEFING

1. The plan — what we cut, in what order
2. The hazards — lines, root ball, spring poles, hangers, bees
3. The escape routes — cleared, not just noticed
4. Stop-work signal — flat hand held up. Anyone can call it.
5. Who calls 911, and the location we give
6. Where the truck is, keys in it, route out clear
7. What we are NOT doing today

TANK FOR TANK

Swap sawyer and swamper every tank. At every swap: has anything moved · is the escape path clear · anything hung up above us · chips or dust · are we cooked · any bystanders.

STOP WORK — ANY ONE IS ENOUGH

- A line is down, or a tree is touching / could reach one
- A tree is hung up in another tree
- Anything broken is hanging above the work area
- You cannot say what holds it up or where it goes
- The trunk sounds hollow
- You need to cut above shoulder height
- The chain brake does not stop the chain
- Your partner is in your zone and you did not nod him in
- You are alone
- You are too tired to answer the six questions honestly

ONE LINE FROM EVERY MODULE

- 00 Before every cut: what is holding this up, and where does it go when it moves?
- 01 Helmet, eyes, ears, gloves, chaps, boots. Both people, every time.
- 01 No solo saw work. Ever.
- 02 Chain catcher present, brake tested, E-clip on the drum, filter sealed. Every start-up.
- 04 Check bar oil is throwing: part throttle, bar tip over a stump, look for the line.
- 05 Pitch · gauge · drive links — all three off the bar stamp. All three must match.
- 06 Big square chips = sharp. Fine dust = dull or rakers low. Curved cut = one side filed harder.
- 07 Carry 2–4 sharp spare chains per saw. Swap is 3 minutes; field filing is 20.
- 08 Clutch cover off and cleaned every day. Packed sawdust is why chain brakes fail.
- 09 Thumb wrapped. Left elbow straight. Body out of the plane of the bar. Never above the shoulder.
- 10 The nod: swamper stays out until the sawyer makes eye contact and nods him in. Saw braked or off first.
- 11 Cut compression side first, then tension side — or bore it.
- 11 Hung-up tree or tree leaning on another tree: refuse the job.
- 12 Every downed line is energized. Stay 30 ft back. Call 911, then KIUC 808-246-4300.
- 12 Near a line: shuffle out, feet together, small steps. Never a long stride.
- 13 Compression cut first, tension cut second. Or bore it.
- 13 Never limb across your body. Chain brake on every step you take.
- 14 Clear the smalls and both escape routes before any cut. 45° back, 15–20 ft.
- 14 Nobody in the drop zone. Two tree lengths. Call it out loud.
- 00 If you can't answer both, you don't cut. Flag it and wait.
- 01 Trauma kit within 60 seconds: tourniquet, packing gauze, pressure bandage.
- 01 Know before you start: who calls 911, what you tell them, where the truck is.
- 03 Brake · catcher · bar · chain · sprocket · nuts · filter · plug · fuel & oil · muffler · mounts · cord.
- 04 Oil tank still full after a tank of fuel = oiler failed. Stop.
- 05 Storm cleanup chain is semi-chisel. Dirt kills full chisel in one cut.
- 06 Every tooth the same length. Re-check rakers every few sharpenings.
- 07 Cutters point forward along the TOP of the bar. Check before you tension.
- 09 Kickback zone = upper quadrant of the bar nose. Never let it touch.
- 10 Tank for tank. Swap roles every time the tank runs dry.
- 10 Swamper's job: pieces clear, piles sorted, work face open, escape path clear, sawyer's back watched.
- 11 Never work on the inside of a root ball.
- 11 Look up before, during, and after every cut.
- 12 Tree touching a line, or could fall into one: not a volunteer job. Full stop.
- 12 Line on a vehicle: stay inside. Only get out for fire, and then jump clear.
- 13 Limb from the uphill side, butt to tip, log between you and the bar.
- 14 Near a structure, road or line = not a volunteer job.
- 14 Hinge: even thickness, ~10% of diameter. Never cut through it.

OUR CREW

Location (as you'd tell a dispatcher)

Who calls 911

Nearest vehicle access

Signal here?

Allergies / epi-pen
